

- **Batch files (.bat) and scripts:** best when you want a reliable, repeatable “do these commands in this order” flow (cleanup, backup, copy/rename). Batch files are plain text scripts with .bat/.cmd extensions that run multiple commands without manual intervention.

We'll build automations that make sense for Indian daily laptop reality: college submissions, office work, WFH, shared family PCs, flaky Wi-Fi days, and the eternal Downloads folder apocalypse.

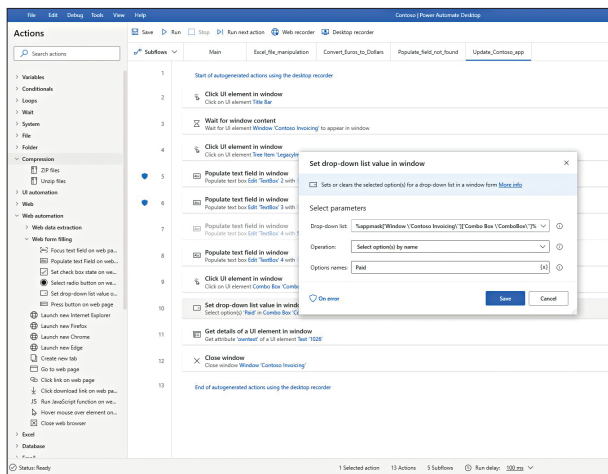
1) Power Automate Desktop: automate the stuff you normally click

Power Automate for desktop is Microsoft's official app for building, editing, and running desktop flows.

If you've ever thought, “Why am I doing *this* again?” – copying data from one place to another, downloading reports, filling a portal form, renaming files – Power Automate is often the cleanest answer.

What Power Automate Desktop is great at

- Automating web portal routines (download monthly bills, upload compliance docs, scrape a report into Excel)
- Automating copy-paste workflows (mail → spreadsheet → folder → rename)
- Automating UI-based tasks in apps that don't provide APIs (older office tools, legacy enterprise apps)



Step-by-step: Install Power Automate for desktop (official route)

Microsoft's install doc explains that Power Automate for desktop is the app you use to build/edit/run desktop flows.

1. Go to the official install flow for Power Automate for desktop and download/install it using Microsoft's documented steps.
2. Launch Power Automate for desktop after install.

(In many Windows 11 setups, it may already be present or easy to install via Microsoft channels; the doc is the source of truth.)

Step-by-step: Create your first “recorded” flow (the quickest win)

A beginner-friendly approach is recording the actions once, then re-running them.

1. Open Power Automate for desktop.
2. Create a New flow.
3. Use the Recorder to capture a simple workflow:
 - Open browser
 - Go to a site
 - Click a menu item
 - Download a file
4. Stop recording, then Run the flow to verify it works.

Power Automate desktop flows are designed for this “drag-and-drop actions or record your own” experience.

Step-by-step: Run desktop flows from shortcuts (so it feels “one click”)

Microsoft documents that you can run desktop flows via run URLs and desktop shortcuts, and trigger them from places like browsers, Run (Win+R), Command Prompt, and Task Scheduler.

1. In Power Automate, create a desktop shortcut (supported by the run-via-shortcuts feature).
2. Pin that shortcut to Start or Taskbar.
3. Now your automation behaves like an app: click → it runs.

Why this matters: the biggest reason automations fail is friction. If running the automation takes longer than doing the task manually, you'll stop using it. Shortcuts fix that.

2) Task Scheduler: time-based and event-based automation (the grown-up alarm clock)

Task Scheduler is Windows' built-in automation engine. It runs tasks by monitoring triggers and then executing actions when those criteria are met.

Triggers can be time-based (daily/weekly) or event-based (startup/logon).

When Task Scheduler is the best tool

- “Do this every day at 9:30 AM”
- “Run this when I log in”
- “Run this every Sunday night”
- “Run this after the laptop wakes up”
- “Run maintenance when nobody is using the machine”

Step-by-step: Create a simple scheduled task (GUI method)

1. Open Start → search Task Scheduler → open.
2. Click Create Basic Task...
3. Name it clearly: “Open Work Apps” / “Weekly Cleanup Reminder”
4. Choose a trigger:
 - Daily (for routine)